VISTRY GROUP

PROPOSED RESIDENTIAL DEVELOPMENT,
R6 R7 Woodlands, South Marston

Landscape, Ecological & Arboricultural Management Plan

August 2024 | LA5979-LEAMP-01 A

Placemaking for life

Quality Assurance

ISO 9001 & 14001 Registered Firm

IDP Landscape Ltd is a practice of Chartered Landscape Architects and a registered company with the Landscape Institute. This report has been prepared in accordance with the Guidelines for Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment 3rd Edition, and the opinions expressed within it are those of qualified Landscape Architects, whose professional judgement is relied upon.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1.0 INTRODUCTION 1

2.0 MANAGEMENT OBJECTIVES 4

3.0 ECOLOGICAL & ARBORICULTURAL POTENTIAL AND CONSTRAINTS 6

4.0 ARBORICULTURAL SURVEY 8

5.0 PROPOSED LANDSCAPE SCHEME 11

6.0 MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES 12

7.0 LANDSCAPE MANAGEMENT CLAUSES 13

GENERAL 13

TREE WORK 14

AMENITY GRASS AREAS 15

SHRUBS/TREES/HEDGES 16

HARD LANDSCAPE AREAS/FENCING 19

8.0 MAINTENANCE AND MANAGEMENT ONGOING 20

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For detailed soft landscape design refer to:

IDPL-LA5979-BP-400 - Soft Landscape GA

IDPL-LA5979-BP-401 - Soft Landscape 1 of 3

IDPL-LA5979-BP-402 - Soft Landscape 2 of 3

IDPL-LA5979-BP-403 - Soft Landscape 3 of 3

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1. IDP Landscape Ltd are appointed by Vistry Group to provide the landscape management plan for Parcels R6 R7 of the proposed phased housing development at Woodlands in South Marston Comprising 137 units and areas of Public Open Space. The development is subject to outline planning approval with conditions attached. Planning Condition 11 requires the submission of a landscape, ecological and arboricultural management plan (LEAMP) for each Reserved Matters application.

Planning Condition 11 states:

"Landscape, Ecology and Arboricultural Management Plan (LEAMP) Each reserved matters application shall be accompanied by a Landscape, Ecology and Arboricultural Management Plan (LEAMP). The LEAMP shall be informed by the FLEAMPs approved under Condition 10 above and updated Phase 2 surveys where the last Phase 2 surveys undertaken for the site are more than 2 years old. The LEAMP shall include:

a) Details of the retention of any species receptor sites identified by the Phase 2 surveys for the site;

b) Details of protection for water courses and aquatic habitats against physical and chemical disturbance or pollution;

c) Details of long term objectives, extent and type of new planting; and

d) Details of any new habitat created on site, management responsibilities and maintenance schedules for all landscaped and habitat areas (except privately owned domestic gardens), and the sequencing for provision.

No development on each sub-phase shall commence until the LEAMP for that sub-phase has been approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority. Thereafter development on each sub-phase shall be progressed in accordance with the approved LEAMP. No development, works or other activities to the identified receptor sites shall be progressed other than in accordance with the works for ecological enhancement and management as set out in the approved LEAMP. The approved management and maintenance schedules shall be adhered to at all times. The submitted LEAMP shall be in accord with the approved Open Space Strategy. Reason: To protect wildlife and supporting habitats and to secure opportunities for biodiversity enhancement."

1.1.1. The aim of this LEAMP is to demonstrate how the proposed development design as detailed within

the Reserved Matters submission is in compliance with the principles and objectives set out within the previously approved FLEAMP dated 21st November 2023.

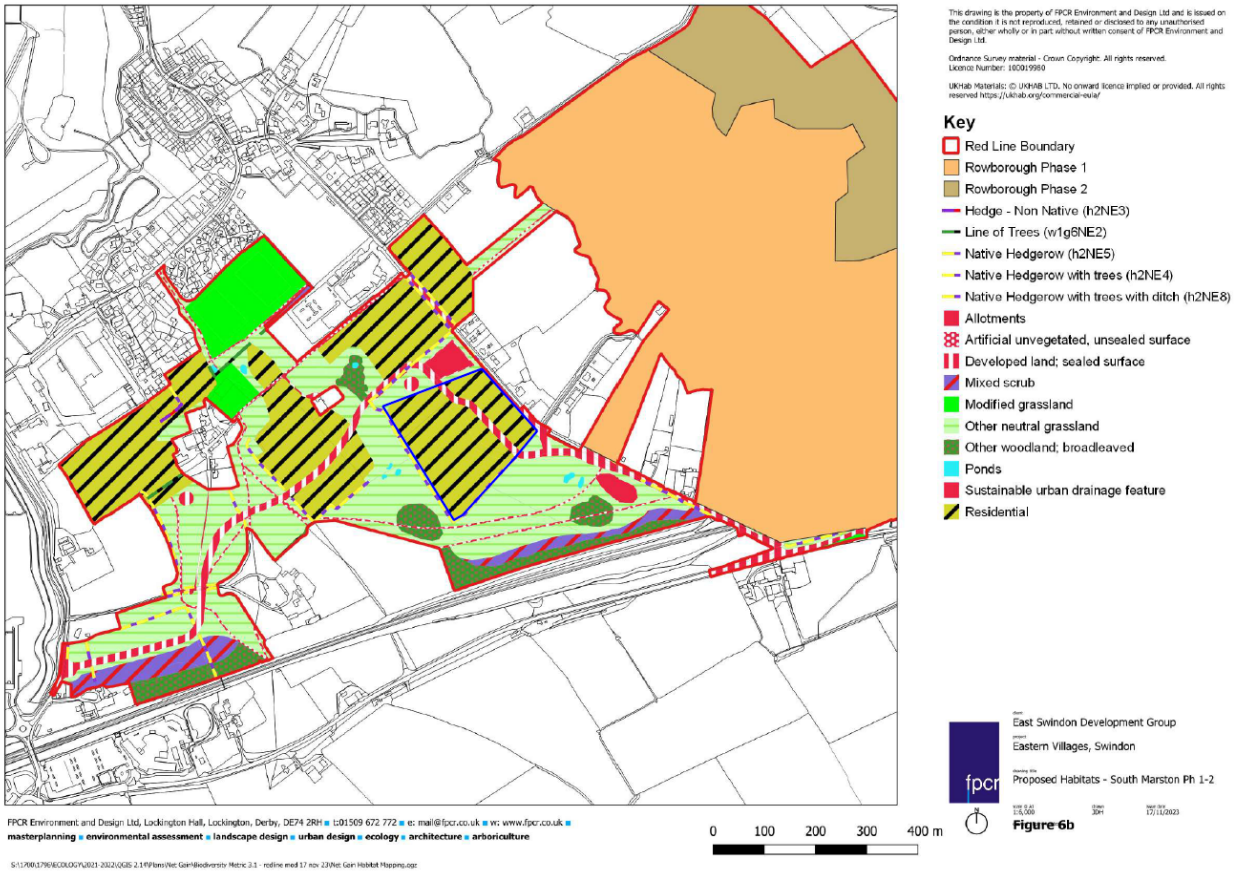

Figure 1 – Development Phase (blue boundary) is shown in relation to outline schemes proposed habitats (not to scale) (source: FPCR Eastern Villages Swindon (South Marston) –FLEAMP Rev E Nov 2023)

1.2. This LEAMP will include long term objectives for the landscape scheme, management responsibilities, and appropriate maintenance schedules etc. for all landscape areas in line with the condition. The maintenance schedules for this site cover a 15-year period, although it is anticipated that it will remain in place for ongoing maintenance by those responsible for the long-term management of the site.

1.3.

1.4. Best practise working procedures will be adhered to at all times during the construction works, and key works will be undertaken by fully trained operatives. A copy of this management plan will be kept on site where it would be available at all times.

1.5. For detailed soft landscape plans refer to:

- IDPL-LA5979-BP-400 - Soft Landscape GA
- IDPL-LA5979-BP-401 - Soft Landscape 1 of 3
- IDPL-LA5979-BP-402 - Soft Landscape 2 of 3
- IDPL-LA5979-BP-403 - Soft Landscape 3 of 3

2.0 MANAGEMENT OBJECTIVES

2.1. The overall objective of this plan is to maintain a high quality and appropriate landscape setting to the development, enhance ecological value, and ensure elements within it are managed to complement the development and its general appearance, and the end users of the site.

2.2. The landscape areas will be sympathetically managed to increase the ecological value of the site generally, and will provide suitable green infrastructure throughout the site in the long term to provide positive links with the surrounding area.

2.3. In broad terms, the site forms a parcel of agricultural land lying between the small village of South Marston to the north and the A420 and the Great Western railway line to the south. The site will be accessed via a new access road running between an upgraded junction off the A420 to the south and Thornhill Road to the west. The site is bounded by small number of existing intact hedgerows and dispersed mature hedgerow trees.

2.4. Most of the site's boundary vegetation will be retained and integrated into the structural landscape of the proposals. The majority of the adjoining existing vegetation will be retained. There will be limited vegetation removals required to enable vehicular access through the existing hedgerows with replacements provided where appropriate.

Management Objectives

2.5. The general objectives for landscape areas are to:

- apply best practice to all horticultural and ecological operations;
- ensure the establishment and future sustained growth of all plants, trees, hedges, grass, and wildflower areas;
- create new habitat areas as part of the benefits of the proposal to enhance wildlife value and species diversity through careful management;
- introduce structural diversity within the existing woodland areas;
- ensure good horticultural practice in the long-term health and vitality of all trees, shrubs and hedges to promote healthy and vigorous growth;
- manage the range of grasslands proposed to the benefit of potential amphibian and invertebrate populations;

- ensure the consistent control of weeds and invasive species;
- provide protection against pests and diseases as appropriate;
- ensure the replacement of defective plant material;
- review opportunities for enhancing planted areas and replacing worn-out areas of planting where appropriate, in line with the original design aspirations.

3.0 ECOLOGICAL & ARBORICULTURAL POTENTIAL AND CONSTRAINTS

Summary of Latest Ecological Survey Results

3.1.1. The guidance and recommendations outlined in the FLEAMP were informed by a Habitat Condition Assessment Survey was undertaken by Peter Hoy (FISC 5 botanical surveyor) and James Hutchison (FISC 4 botanical surveyor). Table 2 below outlines the latest identified ecological constraints and recommendations in relation to the application site.

Table 2.1: Summary of survey findings and recommendations

Valued Ecological Receptor (Nature Conservation Significance)	Guidance
Mature trees (Local / Low)	Existing trees will require management in the future. Where existing mature trees are retained within Green Infrastructure, these trees will only be subject to arboricultural management where it is either imperative for public safety or there are clear benefits for wider biodiversity. Footpaths within green space with public access will be designed to be set at appropriate distances so that they can be maintained with retention of deadwood, cavities and decay as these features will be important for the whole tree ecosystem. Older trees will naturally develop deadwood and cavities which increase their biodiversity value over time. Assessment of tree health, disease and features of biodiversity value will form part of any targeted management plans with the trees located in spaces that will be accessible for inspections and any tree surgery if required. In addition to existing trees, new trees will be incorporated into proposals in areas of proposed parkland, such as the South Marston Country Park. These will provide additional structural diversity to open areas and provide steeping stone habitats through development parcels, along both Primary Streets (e.g. Parkland Way) and Secondary Streets
Hedgerows (Local / Low)	Hedgerows and ditches define the field pattern. A number of the hedges are tall and thick containing a number of mature trees, others are variable in quality, largely due to current management practices. As well as some seasonally wet ditches

	associated with hedge lines, there are some small field ponds within the site. Small areas of broad-leaved woodland occur in association with field ponds. In order to provide some definition between public and private space, native hedgerows would be planted to provide an interface between and into built development parcels with appropriate gaps to allow pedestrian access through to the wider green infrastructure. Timber post and rail/estate fencing would be placed on the development side of the hedge.
Modified Grassland (Low)	Management of this amenity grassland type through regular cutting would seek to ensure a sward height of between 40-50mm during the growing season to ensure resilience to drought and avoid the need for chemical fertilizers and herbicides. In order to achieve moderate condition and provide sufficient species diversity and a greater diversity of flowing herbs initial soil testing will be undertaken to identify soil nutrient status, which will help inform the future management /monitoring strategy. Where soil phosphate levels are high and monitoring indicates that excessive growth of more vigorous /coarse species is preventing the establishment of other species a more intensive cutting regime will be implemented in the early years of establishment to reduce soil nutrient status, followed by the localised use of yellow rattle to aid in reducing the vigour of more competitive grasses.

3.1.2.

4.0 ARBORICULTURAL SURVEY

4.1.1. The arboricultural surveys were carried out in 2015 and 2017 in support of the outline planning application. On the whole, in January 2017 trees were found to be in much the same condition as the review during 2015. An updated survey was carried out in May 2024. The results of the latest survey where is relates to the application site is summarised below.

Tree / Group / Hedgerow No.	Condition	Action (as part of the proposed application)
T33 - Fraxinus excelsior	Fair – declining with some signs of regrowth within hedgerow.	Retain
T34 - Quercus robur	Fair - Visible deadwood and branch damage within crown. Evidence of possible water-logging ground contributing to the dieback and amount of accumulated deadwood. Recommendation would be to remove deadwood in the interests of safety.	Retain
T35 - Quercus robur	Fair - Tearout wound to southern branch at 4m Crown showing decline Visible deadwood and branch damage within crown. Evidence of possible water-logging ground contributing to the dieback and amount of accumulated deadwood. Recommendation would be to remove deadwood in the interests of safety.	Retain
T36 - Fraxinus excelsior	Fair - Selfset within hedgeline.Twin stem 1m above ground level with moderate stature. Part suppressed to East by T37. Minor branch damage. Minor deadwood.	Retain
T40 - Fraxinus excelsior	Good - Specimen is part of hedgerow and has a form comprising co-dominant stems	Retain
T41 - Fraxinus excelsior	Fair - Form comprises a heavily weighted branch to South West. Located within hedgerow. Minor branch degradation. Dense Ivy to 6m	Retain
T42 - Quercus robur	Fair - Heavily waterlogged on the northern side at the time of the resurvey. Symmetrical crown structure with visible dieback and major deadwood distribution throughout which may be due to localised waterlogging of the ground. Recommend deadwood to be removed. May need to heavily reduce crown.	Remove

T44 - Fraxinus excelsior	Poor - Old pollarded specimen with signs of general decline and decaying thoughtout with a hollow base. Recommend for pruning in the interests of safety (East side overhangs highway).	Remove
T45 - Fraxinus excelsior	Poor - Decaying leader orientated towards highway. Branch damage with visible fungal bracket (Inonotus hispidus). Stem appears to be hollowing. Recommend repollard to remove the decaying leader on safety grounds.	Retain
T46 - Salix fragilis	Poor - Main leader failed into the field to the northwest of the stem location. Remove specimen.	Retain
T47 - Salix fragilis	Poor - Whole stem failed into the field to the northwest Stump with minor regrowth. Recommended for removal.	Remove
T48 - Salix fragilis	Fair - Leaning at 25 degrees to the northwest, recommend coppice to reduce chance of failure. Self set with stem leaning to West. Typical form of species otherwise.	Remove
T49 - Salix fragilis	Poor - Collapsed in the past and regrown. Multi stemmed form with three main stems and one cut back on the western side	Remove
T50 - Salix fragilis	Poor - Poor form with major failure of main stem. Open wound with structural decay, stem lying on ground. Hollow stem potentially. Recommend pollard to 2m height and remove fallen stem.	Remove
T51 - Salix fragilis	Fair - Leader snapped 2m above union with stem in field to the northwest, remove failed limb	Retain
H34 - Crataegus monogyna, Prunus spinosa, Ulmus spp	Fair - Internal field boundary hedgerow. Contains many dead elm as well as some elder and willow Unmanaged with an outgrown form. The hedgerow is not continuous and has a number of gaps.	Partial Removal
H35 - Crataegus monogyna, Prunus spinosa,	Fair - Internal field boundary hedgerow Regularly trimmed to maintain a consolidated form and shape. It contains a some elm at it's northern end The hedgerow is not continuous and has a number of gaps.	Partial Removal
H36 - Crataegus monogyna, Prunus spinosa,	Fair - Internal field boundary hedgerow Not maintained for several years, dead elm present Has been regularly trimmed in the past to maintain a consolidated form and	Remove

	shape though is now slightly outgrown. The blackthorn is predominantly at either end of the hedge with the central section being mainly hawthorn. The eastern end contains some elm and the middle section is broken	
H38 - Prunus spinosa,	Good - Internal field boundary hedgerow Has been regularly trimmed in the past to maintain a consolidated form and shape though is now slightly outgrown, no recent management.	Retain
H40 - Crataegus monogyna, Prunus spinosa,	Good - Roadside hedgerow. Regularly trimmed to maintain a consolidated form and shape. Predominantly hawthorn	Retain
TG28 - Salix fragilis	Fair - Most of the trees are old pollards. Selected trees have collapsed stems and associated cracks/splits. Some recent branch removals and possible storm damage remediation. Some younger trees have failed also Recommend removing failed stems and undertaking remedial work if public access is to be considered in close proximity.	Retain
TG29 - Salix fragilis	Fair - Old pollards. Recently collapsed leaving rotting stumps. It would be recommended to pollard the specimens and retain for habitat.	Retain

4.1.2. During site clearance and construction phases hedgerows and trees to be retained should be protected throughout these phases following British Standard methods stated in planning condition 12 Tree and Hedgerow Retention. Gaps in existing retained hedgerows will be planted with a diversity of native woody species. Following removals, where possible leave dead wood, which is valuable to wildlife in shade to rot slowly.

5.0 PROPOSED LANDSCAPE SCHEME

5.1. The proposed landscape scheme will deliver a diverse range of landscape planting that will in time develop into viable habitats that will replace those existing that are removed to allow development while also augmenting and enhancing those that are retained.

5.2. The proposed development necessitates the removal of 6no. trees and 286 lm of hedgerows as well as areas of improved grassland. The proposed landscape scheme will deliver 113 new trees, 274.1 lm of native mixed hedgerows and 155 lm of pollinator friendly ornamental hedges. The proposed landscape scheme includes new areas of meadow grassland comprising 217.5m2 of Emorsgate EM2 General Purpose Wildflower Mix and 810m2 of Emorsgate EH1 Hedgerow Mixture.

5.3. The management clauses for the proposed landscape scheme is set out below in Section 7.0.

6.0 MANAGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1. For the purpose of this document the following terms and responsibilities are defined as follows;

a) *The Developer* – Vistry Group who are responsible for the development of the site.

b) *The Landscape Contractor* – A sub-contractor who is responsible for implementing the landscape scheme to the approved drawings and will be instructed directly by the Developer. The Landscape Contractor will be liable for any failures to the planting and for the replacement planting during the rectification period.

c) *The Management Company* – The company who will be responsible for the upkeep and ongoing maintenance of the landscape areas following completion and handover from the Landscape Contractor. The Management Company will be responsible for any replacement planting required after the rectification period.

7.0 LANDSCAPE MANAGEMENT CLAUSES

GENERAL

7.1. These clauses should be read in conjunction with the proposed landscape scheme to enable the appropriate ongoing management and maintenance of planted areas.

7.2. All landscape maintenance operations, where they do not conflict with ecology operations, should be in accordance with BS 4428:1989 *'Code of practice for general landscape operations'* (excluding hard surfaces). Ongoing landscape maintenance operations are to be in accordance with sound ecological principles, and where relevant to be in accordance with BS 7370-4:1993 *'Grounds Maintenance Recommendations for maintenance of soft landscape'* (other than amenity turf).

7.3. It is intended that the landscape scheme will be implemented by a Landscape Contractor appointed by Vistry Group, and upon completion will hand over the ongoing maintenance responsibilities of each landscaped area to the Management Company.

7.4. The Management Company will be responsible for the maintenance of all landscaped areas during the life of the development. The rectification period shall be for 12 months, after which the Management Company is liable for any failures and necessary replanting.

7.5. The Contractor will be responsible for retaining the appropriate ecologists to carry out the monitoring of proposed mitigation measures for protected species, including badgers located in the northwest corner of the site.

7.6. Generally the management company is responsible for the following:

- **Watering:** Ensure water supply is available for necessary application to wet to field capacity, as necessary for the continued thriving of all planting.
- **Litter and debris:** Collect and remove from site all extraneous litter or debris found in those planted areas included within the maintenance responsibilities.
- **Leaving the site in a good condition:** Removing any soil or arisings from hard surfaces. Ensure protection of existing grassed areas during maintenance operations. Do not place excavated or imported materials directly on grass.
- **Dead plants**: During the rectification period replacement planting is the responsibility of the

landscape contractor. In the subsequent years this will be the responsibility of the management company.

- **Weather damage**: Plants which have been subject to frost heave or wind rock and are therefore struggling to establish.

TREE WORK

7.7. General

7.7.1. A pre-commencement site meeting shall be held prior to any works commencing on site, to agree all approved processes with: the Arboricultural Consultant, the tree works contractor, and the main contractor. This meeting could be used to formally agree the methods of work, position of site offices, material storage, compounds, parking and tree protection measures prior to commencement of the development and the associated clearance work.

7.7.2. All permitted or approved tree works shall be carried out to the highest standards, based on British Standard 3998:2010 'Recommendations for Tree Work' and current best practice. To ensure standards are met it is recommended that a contractor from the Approved List of the Arboricultural Association be used (01242 522152, www.trees.org.uk). Under no circumstances shall site personnel undertake any tree pruning operations.

7.7.3. All tree surgery works should be carried out prior to the erection of protective fencing and before site preparation works are started.

7.7.4. Before any tree works commence, a schedule should be submitted to the main contractor to agree any tree works that become apparent during the construction process. Refer to Arboricultural Implications Assessment and Tree Protection Method Statement for full details of tree works. Works should ideally be carried out during the tree's dormant period from November through to February and then again from June to August.

7.7.5. Notice should be given of any defective, diseased, unsafe or weak parts of trees in addition to those scheduled for attention.

7.8. Supervision

7.8.1. On-going arboricultural site monitoring for the duration of the proposed development will be carried out by the Arboricultural Consultant at pre-determined and agreed time intervals, and governed by the type, timing, location and intensity of site works.

7.8.2. A site visit report will be provided listing the efficiency of the tree protection measures, any

defects requiring rectification or other relevant comments relating to the management of the tree stock. The report will be provided to the client, and the main contractor/site manager.

7.9. **Removing trees, shrubs and hedges**

7.9.1. The Preliminary Arboricultural Method Statement & Tree Protection Plan by Hayden's should be referred to for details of the agreed tree removals and works to retained trees. All works should be carried out to standards BS 3998, Soft Landscape Proposal drawings 101-103 and Health & Safety Executive (HSE)/ Arboricultural and Forestry Advisory Group Safety Leaflets.

7.9.2. The contractor should check for below and above ground services, and give notice if they may be affected.

AMENITY GRASS AREAS

7.10. **General**

7.10.1. Grassed areas should be maintained for a healthy vigorous sward, free from disease, fungal growth, discolouration, scorch or wilt.

7.10.2. Ornamental lawns should be maintained reasonably free from moss, excessive thatch, weeds, frost heave, worm casts and mole hills.

7.11. **Grass Cutting**

7.11.1. Before mowing, remove litter, rubbish and debris and deposit off-site.

7.11.2. The height of the first cut should be 40 mm once the initial growth has reached 75 mm. Maintain general grass areas between 50 and 75 mm. All arisings should be removed from the surface.

7.11.3. Ensure a neat and even finish, without surface rutting, compaction or damage to grass. Leave neat and well defined edges. Neatly trim around obstructions, especially trees where damage to bark etc. should be prevented.

7.11.4. Adjoining hard areas should be swept clear and arisings removed.

7.11.5. Apply organic fertilizer at a rate of 60 g/m^2 twice annually in spring and autumn in line with manufacturers recommendations.

7.12. **Cutting regime (Meadowgrass – EM2 General Purpose Meadow Mix)**

7.12.1. Newly sown wetland meadows to be mown regularly throughout the first year of establishment to a height of 40-60mm, removing cuttings if dense. This will control annual weeds and help maintain balance between faster growing grasses and slower developing wild flowers.

7.12.2. In subsequent years, grass cutting/strimming of 60% of the area should take place following flowering of wildflowers and when seeds have ripened and fallen i.e. Aug/Sept. Cut to a height of 150mm, removing cuttings if dense after the plants have flowered. A spring cut of the remaining 40% area, as necessary, will keep rank species in check; cuttings will contain seed from these plants and so should be removed.

7.12.3. To ensure that their seed will germinate, it may be necessary to over-seed with an appropriate seed mix to increase the floral diversity, especially where there are bare patches.

7.13. **Bulbs and corms**

7.13.1. Do not cut grass areas containing bulbs before flowering.

7.13.2. Delay topping leaves/stems of bulbs up to six to eight weeks after flowering has finished. Then cut to ground level and remove all arisings.

SHRUBS/TREES/HEDGES

7.14. **General**

7.14.1. Maintain a weed free area around each tree and shrub, minimum diameter the larger of 1m or the surface of the original planting pit.

7.14.2. Remove dead flower heads, fallen leaves, litter and debris and deposit off-site in order to maintain a tidy and clean appearance to the shrub areas.

7.14.3. Fork over beds to keep soil loose, with gentle cambers and no hollows. Do not reduce depth or effect of mulch.

7.14.4. Where grass edges meet planting beds, trim grass edges and remove arisings.

7.14.5. Refirm plants/trees around the base until firmly bedded following strong winds and other disturbances.

7.14.6. Check and adjust/refix tree guards, stakes and ties or replace defective elements, allowing for growth and to prevent chafing.

7.15. **Pruning generally**

7.15.1. Pruning should be carried out in accordance with good horticultural and arboricultural practice.

7.15.2. When pruning, make cuts above and sloping away from an outward facing healthy bud, angled so that water will not collect on cut area.

7.15.3. Thin, trim and shape each specimen appropriately to species, location, season, and stage of growth, leaving a well-balanced natural appearance.

7.15.4. Remove growth encroaching onto grassed areas, paths, roads, signs, sightlines and road lighting luminaires annually.

7.15.5. Prune ornamental shrubs to encourage healthy and bushy growth and desirable ornamental features e.g. flowers, fruit, autumn colour, stem colour.

7.15.6. Remove suckers by cutting back level with the source stem or root.

7.16. **Pruning flowering species of shrubs and roses**

7.16.1. Time of year:

- Winter flowering shrubs: Spring
- Shrubs flowering between March and July: Immediately after the flowering period
- Shrubs flowering between July and October: Back to old wood in winter
- Rose bushes: Early spring to encourage basal growths and a balanced, compact habit

7.17. **Pruning new hedges**

7.17.1. Allow rapidly establishing hedges to reach planned height as quickly as possible.

7.17.2. Trim back lateral branches moderately.

7.17.3. Cut back slowly establishing hedges hard in June and September to encourage bushy growth down to ground level.

7.17.4. Allow the hedge to reach planned dimensions only by gradual degrees, depending on growth rate and habit.

7.18. **Formative pruning of young trees**

7.18.1. Ensure that the type and timing of pruning operations suit the plant species.

7.18.2. Do not prune during the late winter/ early spring sap flow period.

7.18.3. Crown prune by removing dead branches and reducing selected side branches by one third to preserve a well-balanced head and ensure the development of a single strong leader. Whips or feathered trees should not be pruned until established.

7.18.4. Remove duplicated branches and potentially weak or tight forks. In each case cut back to live wood.

7.19. **Climbing plants**

7.19.1. When pruning, remove excess growth, to ensure that signs, light fittings, doors and windows are

kept clear at all times.

7.19.2. Insecure growth: Attach to supporting wires or structures using 1 mm diameter black plastics coated steel wire.

7.19.3. Supporting structures: Check and repair as necessary.

7.20. **Dead and diseased plants/trees**

7.20.1. Remove within one week of notification.

7.20.2. Replace plants/trees in the next scheduled round of replacement planting.

7.21. **Removal of dead plant material**

7.21.1. At the end of the growing season, check all shrubs/trees/hedges and remove all dead foliage, dead wood, and broken or damaged branches and stems.

7.22. **Reinstatement of shrub/ herbaceous areas**

7.22.1. In the presence of mulch/ matting materials, carefully move to one side and dig over the soil, leaving it fit for replanting.

7.22.2. Use pit and plants to original specification or to match the size of adjacent or nearby plants of the same species, whichever is the greater.

7.22.3. Apply slow release fertilizer at rate shown by manufacturer's recommendations.

7.23. **Weed control generally**

7.23.1. Ensure weed cover is less than 5% at all times, and no weed to exceed 100 mm high.

7.23.2. Remove the minimum quantity of soil, and disturb plants, bulbs and mulched surfaces as little as possible.

7.23.3. Rake the area to a neat, clean condition and reinstate mulch to original depth.

7.23.4. Use suitable foliar acting herbicide to kill regrowth. Allow recommended period for herbicide to take effect before clearing dead weeds.

7.24. **Soil aeration**

7.24.1. Where compacted soil surfaces arise, prick up with fork to aerate the soil of root areas and break the surface crust.

7.24.2. Do not damage plants and their roots.

7.25. **Maintenance of mulch**

7.25.1. Thickness of mulch to be a minimum of 75 mm and topped up twice per year.

7.25.2. Mulch spill on adjacent areas should be cleared of debris and returned to the planted area.

7.25.3. Remove weeds growing on or in mulch by hand weeding.

7.26. **Fertilizer**

7.26.1. Apply during February or March using a slow release fertilizer, spreading evenly at a rate as recommended by the manufacturer.

HARD LANDSCAPE AREAS/FENCING

7.27. **Hard surfaces and gravel areas**

7.27.1. Apply a suitable foliar acting or residual herbicide to manage weed growth. Allow recommended period for herbicide to take effect before clearing arisings.

7.27.2. Remove litter, leaves and other debris from all hard surfaces.

7.27.3. Remove mud, silt and debris from surface gutters and channels.

7.27.4. Empty traps and flush clean drainage gullies.

7.27.5. Rake over any gravel areas and remove weeds, litter, leaves and debris, and level off.

7.27.6. Repair paving areas in accordance with the original paving specification or BS 7370-2, clause 4.12.

7.27.7. Stain removal in accordance with BS 7370-2, table 4.

7.28. **Timings**

7.28.1. Layout of the POS to be completed prior to the 100th occupation of dwelling.

7.28.2. Installation of furniture to be within 12 months of layout of POS.

7.29. **Defects**

Where defects occur, areas are to be cordoned off immediately to ensure safety, with repairs / replacement undertaken at the earliest opportunity using materials to match those originally specified. Manufacturer's guidance should be followed for specific equipment.

8.0 MAINTENANCE AND MANAGEMENT ONGOING

8.1. The following table indicates the ongoing maintenance operations to be carried out in year 1 in the period between practical completion and the end of the rectification period.

Maintenance Operations Year 1	Timing of operations (January to December)											
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
General Operations												
Fertiliser: Apply as deemed necessary to top 50mm of soil in accordance with manufacturer's instructions. Replace dislodged mulch materials.			x	x								
Watering: At regular intervals during spring and summer months following planting. Additional watering during dry spells as required.	As required and approved.											
Dead and diseased plants: Remove within one week of notification. Replace plants in the next scheduled round of replacement planting. Replacement plants to original specification or to match the size of adjacent or nearby plants of the same species, whichever is the greater. Apply slow release fertilizer at rate shown to manufacturer's recommendations.	As required and approved.											
Weed control generally: Ensure weed cover is less than 5% at all times, and no weed to exceed 100 mm high. Where manual weed control using hand tools has proved unsuccessful use suitable residual herbicide to manufacturer's instructions.	As required and approved											
Mulch: To all areas of shrub, tree and hedgerow planting to a depth of 75mm, twice per year. Remove weeds growing within the mulch by hand.				x						x		
Clearance of fallen leaves: Leaf litter to be composted offsite. Twice a month or as required.										x	x	x
Litter picking: Emptying and cleaning of litter bins. Contents disposed of off-site.	Weekly or as necessary											
Snow/ice removal: Excessive snow to be removed from plants to avoid damage. Gritting to hard surfaces to be non-toxic, biodegradable and eco-friendly.	As required and approved											
Amenity Grass												
Initial cut: Prior to mowing remove litter, stones and debris and deposit off-site. Cut to 40mm once the initial growth has reached 75mm. Bare areas and those that have failed to thrive are to be reseeded/re-turfed as required. Generally weekly mow during growing season.			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		

Maintenance Operations Year 1	Timing of operations (January to December)											
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Wildflower/ Meadow Grass												
Cutting regime: Following flowering take a midsummer and late summer hay cut to 50mm. Leave arisings in situ and then remove within 7 days of cutting. Mow the regrowth through to late autumn and winter to 50mm. Leave adhoc areas unmown to contribute to habitat diversity.						x	x			x		
Weed control: Control of pernicious weeds by spot application of herbicide as advised by manufacturer.				x	x							
Shrubs/ Herbaceous												
Litter and debris: Remove dead flower heads, fallen leaves and debris.	As required and approved											
Weed control: Maintain weed free area with a minimum diameter of 1m around each plant.	As required and approved											
Hedges												
Stakes and Ties: Adjusted each year to allow for growth.	As required											
Existing hedgerows: Cut back to encourage bushy growth.	x	x	x							x	x	x
Existing and proposed trees												
Stakes, Guards and Ties, Mulch mats: Adjusted each year to allow for growth. Removed when tree has sufficiently established to support itself, usually after 2 years.	As required											
Existing Trees: All trees to be checked to ensure healthy growth and safety. Pruning as required in accordance with BS 3998.	As required											
Crown lifting/thinning: Ensure a clearance of 2.5m above footpaths/roadways to maintain sightlines. Ensure footpaths and routes are clear from obstructions. In subsequent years thinning may be required in accordance with BS3998.	As required and approved											
Monitoring: Remove dead, diseased or dying trees, fungal growths, fruiting bodies, climbing plants and any other foreign objects.	Monthly											
Weed control: Control of pernicious weeds by spot application of herbicide as advised by manufacturer.								x	x			
Hard surfaces and gravel areas												
Weed control to hard surfaces: Apply herbicide to hard surfaces at the start of the growing season or as required.			x	x								
Clean hard surfaces: Remove litter, leaves and other debris from all hard surfaces. Where necessary repair paving areas in accordance with the original paving specification. Remove any stains in accordance with BS 7370-2, table 4.	As required and approved											
Clean drains: Remove mud, silt and debris from surface gutters and channels. Empty traps and flush clean drainage gullies.	As required and approved											
Maintain gravel areas: Rake over any gravel areas and remove weeds, litter, leaves and debris, and level off.	As required and approved											

8.2. The following table indicates the ongoing maintenance operations to be carried out following the end of the rectification period.

Ongoing Maintenance Operations Years 2-15	**Timing of operations (January to December)**											
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
General operations												
Fertiliser: Apply as deemed necessary to top 50mm of soil in accordance with manufacturer's instructions. Replace dislodged mulch materials.			x	x								
Watering: At regular intervals during spring and summer months following planting. Additional watering during dry spells as required.	As required and approved.											
Dead and diseased plants: Remove within one week of notification. Replace plants in the next scheduled round of replacement planting. Replacement plants to original specification or to match the size of adjacent or nearby plants of the same species, whichever is the greater. Apply slow release fertilizer at rate shown to manufacturer's recommendations.	As required and approved.											
Weed control generally: Ensure weed cover is less than 5% at all times, and no weed to exceed 100 mm high. Where manual weed control using hand tools has proved unsuccessful use suitable residual herbicide to manufacturer's instructions.	As required and approved											
Mulch: To all areas of shrub, tree and hedgerow planting to a depth of 75mm, twice per year. Remove weeds growing within the mulch by hand.				x						x		
Clearance of fallen leaves: Leaf litter to be composted offsite. Twice a month or as required.										x	x	x
Litter picking: Emptying and cleaning of litter bins. Contents disposed of off site.	Weekly or as necessary											
Snow/ice removal: Excessive snow to be removed from plants to avoid damage. Gritting to hard surfaces to be non-toxic, biodegradable and eco-friendly.	As required and approved											
Amenity Grass												
Routine cut: Prior to mowing remove litter, stones and debris and deposit off-site. Generally a weekly mow during growing season, and monitor growth to ensure height doesn't exceed 75mm. Mow to a height of 25-30mm and remove arisings offsite. Reseeding and turfing to areas that have failed as necessary.			x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x		
Weed control: Control of perennial weeds by spot application of herbicide as advised by manufacturer.					x							
Wildflower/ Meadow Grass												
Cutting regime: Following flowering take a midsummer and late summer hay cut to 50mm. Leave arisings in situ and then remove within 7 days of cutting. Mow the regrowth through to late autumn and winter to 50mm. Leave adhoc areas unmown to contribute to habitat diversity.						x	x			x		
Weed control: Control of pernicious weeds by spot application of herbicide as advised by manufacturer.				x	x							
Ornamental Grasses												
Depending upon the species grasses are to be cut back/ trimmed.			x	x	x							

Ongoing Maintenance Operations Years 2-15	**Timing of operations (January to December)**											
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Shrubs/ Herbaceous												
Litter and debris: Remove dead flower heads, fallen leaves and debris.	As required and approved											
Weed control: Maintain weed free area with a minimum diameter of 1m around each plant.				x								
Pruning:												
Winter flowering shrubs			x	x								
Shrubs flowering between March and July								x				
Shrubs flowering between July and October: Back to old wood in winter.											x	x
Removal of dead plant material: At the end of the growing season, check all shrubs and remove all dead foliage, dead wood, and broken or damaged branches and stems.										x		
Ornamental Hedgerows												
Pruning: Cut back in winter to encourage busy growth and achieve planning height and width.	x	x	x							x	x	x
Existing and proposed trees												
Existing Trees: All trees to be checked to ensure healthy growth and safety. Pruning as required in accordance with BS 3998.												
Crown lifting/thinning: Ensure a clearance of 2.5m above footpaths/roadways to maintain sightlines. Ensure footpaths and routes are clear from obstructions.	As required and approved											
Monitoring: Remove dead, diseased or dying trees, fungal growths, fruiting bodies, climbing plants and any other foreign objects.	Monthly											
Thinning: Where the density of cover has increased such that their growth is restricting that of other species. Where possible felled species should be left in situ to provide invertebrate habitat.	As required and approved											
Hard surfaces and gravel areas												
Weed control to hard surfaces: Apply herbicide to hard surfaces at the start of the growing season or as required.			x	x								
Clean hard surfaces: Remove litter, leaves and other debris from all hard surfaces. Where necessary repair paving areas in accordance with the original paving specification. Remove any stains in accordance with BS 7370-2, table 4.	As required and approved											
Clean drains: Remove mud, silt and debris from surface gutters and channels. Empty traps and flush clean drainage gullies.	As required and approved											
Maintain gravel areas: Rake over any gravel areas and remove weeds, litter, leaves and debris, and level off.	As required and approved											

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